

Homework Questions for Schwalbe, “Finding Out How the Social World Works,” in Ferguson, *Mapping the Social Landscape*, and in PDF form on the course website.

1. What are 3 advantages of systematic research? p38
2. What is Schwalbe’s “larger point” about being *sociologically mindful*? p38-9
3. What are *empirical* questions? p39
4. How can the same information be interpreted differently? p40 Can you come up with another example of information about the social world that could be reacted to in very different ways?
5. What does Schwalbe mean by *mindful skepticism*? p41-2
6. According to Schwalbe, how can *sociological mindfulness* lead to *curiosity, care, and hope*? p44-5
7. Briefly describe why rational, empirical approaches to research are important. Do you think “most Americans,” or the general population always cares about facts, or what kinds of arguments in our society continue based on misinformation? Do you think “truth” can eventually triumph?